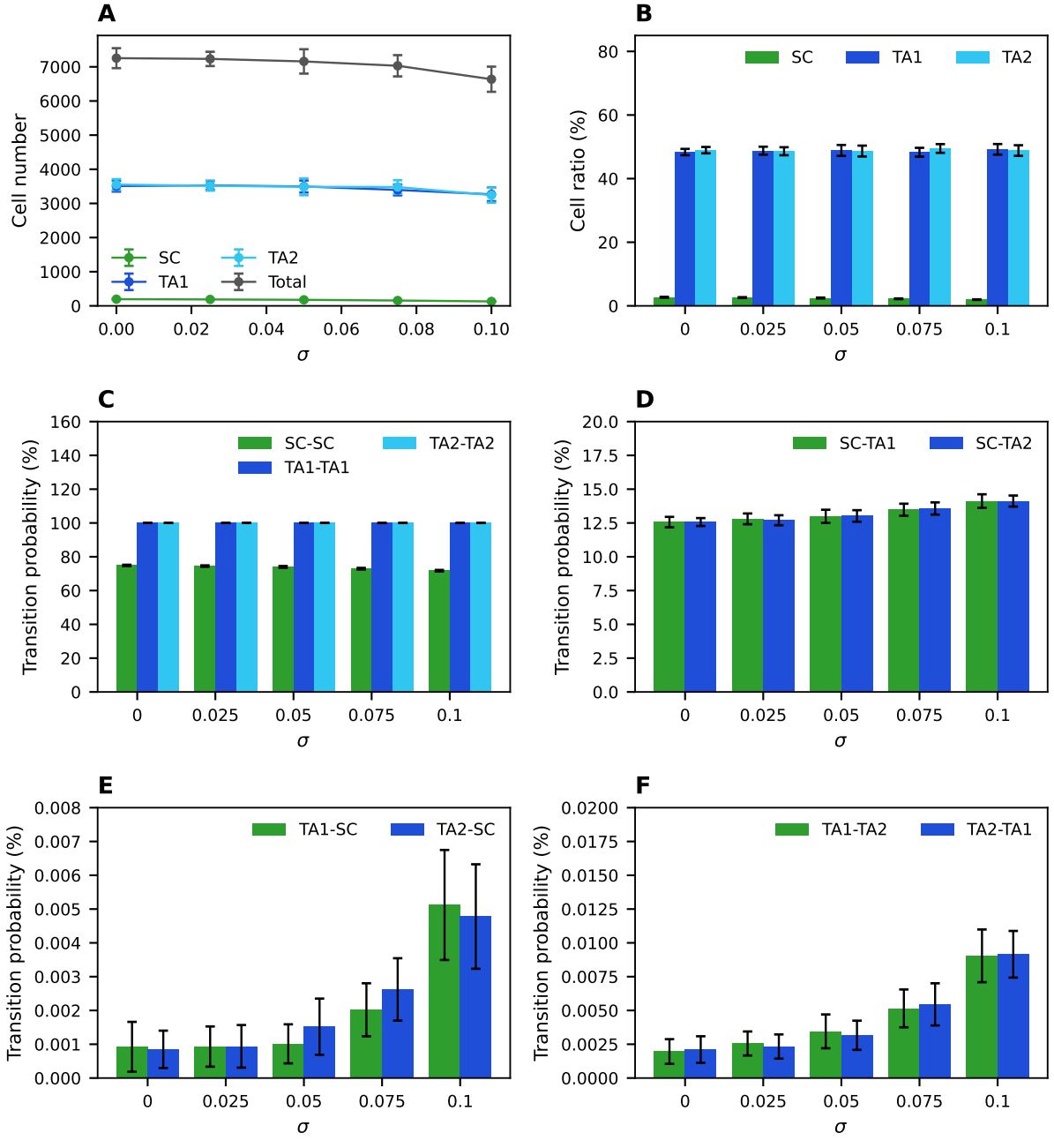Impact of extrinsic noise (Fig. 8)